Annex B. Guidelines for dailies without surveillance

Ground rules so the daily coordinates the team's work instead of controlling people.

According to Scrum, the purpose of the daily is to **inspect progress toward the Sprint goal and adapt the plan**. It is not a report of hours worked for whoever manages. Since the 2020 edition of the Scrum Guide, moreover, the three classic questions ("What did I do yesterday? What will I do today? Do I have any blockers?") are no longer mandatory: the team chooses the structure that serves it best.

To break the feeling of being watched, the following ground rules are proposed.

1 Talk about the work, not about the people

The classic questions can be experienced as a daily judgment. The proposal is to replace them with an approach centered on the board and the product.

Previous approach	Proposed approach
"Juan, tell us what you did yesterday."	"Let's look at this task that's in Testing. What's missing for it to move to Done? Does anyone need help?"

- The board is walked from right to left (from what is closest to done to what has just started).
- The team talks about the **cards**, not about personal agendas.
- **Closing valve:** at the end, one minute to ask "does anyone want to say something the board doesn't show?". It keeps someone who is stuck and silent from going unnoticed.

2 The facilitator accompanies, doesn't judge

Whoever manages or acts as Scrum Master is a **facilitator, not a judge**.

- **Avoid the reporting eye contact.** Developers talk to each other; they don't look at the manager waiting for approval. When remote, the facilitator can turn the camera off or stop taking the center of the screen.
- **Minimal intervention.** They step in only if the team drifts from the goal or if they detect a blocker that requires outside management.
- **No asking for justifications.** If a task didn't move forward, the question is never "why didn't you finish it?", but "*did some unexpected technical complexity come up on that card that we could collaborate on*?".

3 A question about understanding (the age of AI)

Once a week (or at every daily, if the team prefers) include:

> **Did any generated code come in this week that someone on the team can't explain?**

The aim isn't to point at anyone: it is to make cognitive debt visible before it reaches production.

4 Fifteen minutes and "The Parking Lot"

- The daily lasts **15 minutes at most**. This keeps it from becoming a long debate where everyone's knowledge is exposed under pressure.
- If a technical problem requires deep discussion, someone says: "*This goes to the parking lot*".
- When the 15 minutes are up, the daily officially ends. Those who aren't involved in a parking-lot topic are free to leave and protect their focus time.

5 Switch the indicators off afterwards

Once the daily is over, developers are free to close the messaging app or switch to "Do Not Disturb" to enter blocks of uninterrupted work. The daily is the **only required point of synchronous coordination** of the day; any other meeting is voluntary or one-off.

These guidelines are a proposal to try in real teams. It is worth reviewing them with the team after two or three sprints.